DECISION MEMO: A Low-Risk, 12-Month Pilot of an AI Policy-Intelligence Capability for Bangladesh

To: Ministry of Posts, Telecommunications and Information Technology (ICT Division), and relevant authorities: Planning Commission, Finance Division, Legislative and Parliamentary Affairs Division, Bangladesh Bureau of Statistics, a2i, National Data Management Authority
From: Md Naim Hassan Saykat, Independent Researcher (BAPIL) · **Date:** October 2026 · **Basis:** BAPIL Technical Blueprint, Version 1.0 (DOI pending)

Purpose. To request six decisions that would allow a small, safe and open pilot of an AI capability that helps officials find and cite official evidence in Bangla and English.

Why now. (1) The government has announced that drafting of a national AI policy begins in Q4 2026 [91]; a tested, openly licensed blueprint can inform it. (2) The Personal Data Protection Act, 2026 and the National Data Management Act, 2026 now set the rules for public-sector data [85, 86]. (3) Laws, gazettes, budgets and plans are scattered across sites and formats, often as scanned Bangla PDFs, and there is no open Bangla benchmark for policy search.

Proposal. A university-anchored BAPIL lab under an MoU with the ICT Division, a multi-stakeholder Steering Board and an independent Ethics and Risk Review Committee with a binding veto. Year 1 delivers: **P1** a bilingual policy search tool whose answers cite official sources (or abstain), piloted with 30 or more analysts in two to three agencies; **P2** five years of budget allocations as open data; an open **BanglaPolicyQA** benchmark; training for 100 officials; a public transparency register. A tested reference implementation already exists on GitHub.

Safeguards. Public, officially published data first; no personal data without consent, a DPIA and ethics approval; no sensitive personal data. Advice, not decisions: a person reviews every output and no system decides about individuals. No surveillance, social scoring or profiling of opinions. Risk tiers and lifecycle gates; hosting in Bangladesh; open publication of code and evaluations.

Decisions requested.

No.	Decision	Responsible	Timing
D1	Accept the Blueprint as a technical input to national AI policy drafting	ICT Division	Q4 2026
D2	Approve a 12-month Phase 1 pilot with a named focal point and a host-institution MoU	ICT Division, host institution	90 days
D3	Authorise bulk access to already-public document collections; nominate custodians	Custodian agencies	120 days
D4	Nominate Steering Board and independent ERRC members	ICT Division, academia, civil society	90 days
D5	Commission the feasibility and costing study that sets the Phase 2 budget	ICT Division or a partner	Month 6
D6	Confirm guardrails: no deployment beyond advisory use without a G4 decision; no prohibited uses	Steering Board	At charter

Results at month 12. Policy search pilot passing its gate with 30 or more active users and Recall@10 of at least 0.85 on the benchmark; 500 benchmark questions released; five fiscal years of budget allocations published as open data; 100 officials trained; every pilot listed in the transparency register with a model card; a public Year 1 report, including what did not work.

Key risks and mitigations. *Data access delays:* start with documents already online. *Wrong answers:* extractive answers with mandatory citations, abstention and human review. *Mission creep:* prohibited uses written into the charter and an independent veto. *Political change:* university host and alignment with the national AI policy process.

Long-term path (Blueprint Chapter 16). Pilots and governance proven with public data (2027 to 2028); tools adopted by agencies and aligned with the next national AI policy cycle (2029 to 2030); a national policy-intelligence network on shared standards (2031 to 2035); evidence services embedded in policy cycles by 2041, with charter renewal only if a 2041 review confirms public value. Targets are reviewed in 2027, 2028, 2029, 2030, 2035 and 2041.

Resources. About 9 full-time staff in Year 1, rising to 19; two to three servers and one or two inference GPUs. Indicative budget: about Tk 18.5 crore over 36 months (Tk 5.0 crore in Year 1), under one tenth of the reported Bangladesh AI Hub project cost [35]; confirmed by the month-6 costing study.

Links. Blueprint: DOI to be assigned on publication (reserved on Zenodo) · White Paper: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21363967 · Code: https://github.com/md-naim-hassan-saykat/bapil

Independent research proposal; not an official government document. References [35], [85], [86] and [91] are listed in the Technical Blueprint. *CC BY 4.0.*